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5 In situations like this, where I'm not sure how to put things right, I usually carry on with any obvious tasks that need doing while I mull over the problem. In this case, I continued with the hollowing of the bowl, using a 13mm bowl gouge

6 While hollowing the bowl I remembered that the wood bleach has to be neutralised. This involves washing it thoroughly with clean water and then with a solution of white vinegar in water. It's an odd feeling, dunking a wooden bowl in water and scrubbing it

7 When the bowl had dried, it was obvious that the inside was just as badly stained as the outside had been, but I was reluctant to use the bleach again, feeling that the unnaturally white result on the outside had just left me with almost as big a problem as the original stain

8 Persevering a little longer, I decided to use a really dark stain on the inside to cover and mask the sap-staining, but I was reluctant to use a wood-coloured stain because that would make the horse chestnut look like some other timber, which seemed somehow vaguely dishonest. Instead I decided on a definitely non-wood colour and, after sanding to 400 grit, stained it a rich dark purple colour. No-one would recognise it as horse chestnut, but nor would they confuse it with any other timber

9 Staining the inside had given me the brainwave I needed for the outside. After using a soft pencil to draw a design of a double entwined vine with leaves and flowers, I began to go over this with a pyrography pen to burn the design into the wood

10 About four hours later the design was finished. Mounting it back on the lathe and lightly sanding with 400 grit removed any brown charring from the surface, leaving it crisp and clean. It would have been possible to stop at this point and simply seal and polish the outside

11 The black-and-white design worked quite well as it was, but I had already decided that I would add colour to the pyrographed pattern. I used a fine woodstain powder, which can be mixed with alcohol or water. The more powder used, the deeper the colour. I have four colours; red, blue, yellow and black. Greens, purples, etc. are made by mixing these to get the desired shades

12 It took another two or three hours to colour in the design using a small artist's paintbrush to apply two coats of the stain. Application was made relatively easy because the pyrography burn seems to 'cauterise' the wood grain and prevents the stain from bleeding from one area into another

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